



Doyen of the sport: Punjab Sports Minister Gurmeet Singh Meet Hayer honoured World Cup-winning hockey Olympian, retired Brigadier Harcharan Singh. Also present on the dais were The Hindu CEO L.V. Navaneeth and Sportstar Editor Ayon Sengupta. R. V. MOORTHY

Meanwhile, Avneet Kaur Sidhu, an Asian Games medallist in shooting, explained the benefit of inculcating the culture of sports in the younger generation. "My daughter is facing the same challenges I faced 24 years ago. That tells us where we are. We need to channel the energy of the youth towards sport," she said in a session titled "Punjab Fuelling India's Sporting Dreams."

Commonwealth Games silver medallist and Olympian Anjum Moudgil echoed similar sentiments. "If the Government of Punjab truly respects senior athletes and gives them financial and other securities, that's when the youth will be inspired to join sports," Moudgil said.

Sarvjit Singh, Special Chief Secretary, Sports, Punjab,



Bright future: Uday Saharan, captain of the Indian team that reached the final of the U-19 Men's World Cup recently, won the 'Emerging Hero' award. Punjab Cricket Association president, Amarjit Singh, received the award from Gurmeet Singh Meet Hayer on behalf of Saharan. R. V. MOORTHY

underlined the government's focus on improving its coaching pool.

"We had only 300-350 coaches. That number went up eight times straight away. We have made a simple five-step process to select a coach where physical fitness is a core part so that they can inspire the next generation. The written examination will only be secondary," he added.

During the event, Uday Saharan, India's U-19 World Cup captain, was named the Emerging Hero, while Brigadier Harcharan Singh, a member of the 1975 Hockey World Cup-winning team, was named the Hero Unsung Champion.

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